

F5 Daily Briefing – Monday, July 27, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

19

ANNOUNCEMENTS

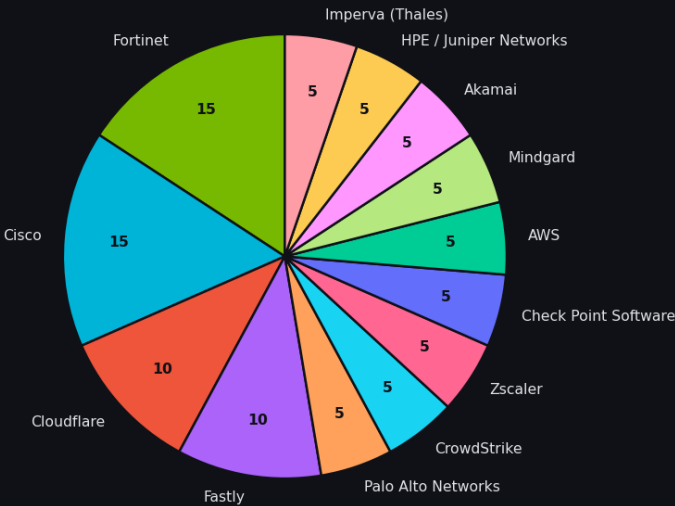
13

ACTIVE

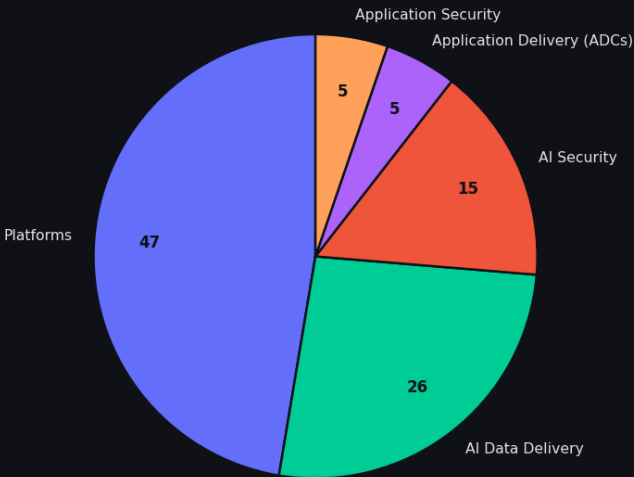
5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (19)

ACQUISITION

Palo Alto Networks

Platforms

2026-07-24

Palo Alto Networks to Acquire Embrace to Expand Observability Platform

Palo Alto Networks announced its intent to acquire observability specialist Embrace to add high-fidelity Real User Monitoring and a new Synthetics multi-location testing capability to its Digital Experience Monitoring stack. The deal follows the January 2026 Chronosphere purchase that pushed observability revenue past \$300M ARR, and integrates with Cortex AgentiX for automated issue detection and remediation. It is expected to close in Q1 of fiscal 2027.

<https://en.it-daily.net/shortnews-en/palo-alto-networks-to-acquire-embrace>

PARTNERSHIP

Fortinet

Platforms

2026-07-24

Fortinet and Intel Partner to Co-Develop Security Processor 6 (SP6)

Fortinet and Intel unveiled a strategic collaboration to co-develop Fortinet's next-generation Security Processor 6 (SP6), combining Fortinet's two-decade ASIC expertise with Intel's chip design, advanced packaging and manufacturing. The partnership aims to deliver higher-performance security processors for enterprise and AI-enabled workloads while diversifying Fortinet's supply chain for greater resilience. Both companies signaled potential for deeper future cooperation across semiconductor technology and infrastructure.

<https://www.eenewseurope.com/en/intel-and-fortinet-team-up-on-sp6-cybersecurity-chip/>

PARTNERSHIP

Fortinet

Platforms

2026-07-24

Fortinet Names Exclusive Networks as Global Distributor

Fortinet named Exclusive Networks as a global distributor, enabling fulfillment of multinational Fortinet deals across 90+ countries with 24/7 support, professional services and global logistics. Executives framed the move as strengthening Fortinet's global partner ecosystem and delivering a seamless experience for large multinational customers. It builds on a 20-year relationship between the two companies.

<https://www.techpartner.news/news/exclusive-networks-named-global-distributor-of-fortinet-627639>

PRODUCT UPDATE

Fortinet

AI Security

2026-07-24

Fortinet Strengthens FortiEndpoint with AI Security and Data Protection

Fortinet expanded FortiEndpoint with AI-driven security features that detect installed AI apps, agents and web-based AI services to surface shadow AI and enforce allow/restrict/monitor/block policies. New native DLP monitors sensitive-data exposure to AI tools, while AI-assisted operations let analysts investigate incidents via natural language and adaptive zero-trust scoring drives access decisions. The updates are expected to ship in Q3 2026.

<https://www.tech-critter.com/fortinet-fortiendpoint-ai-security-data-protection-features/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cisco

Platforms

2026-07-24

Cisco Introduces Antares Open-Weight Models for Local Vulnerability Detection

Cisco Foundation AI announced Antares, a family of open-weight small language models designed for local, secure vulnerability detection inside an organization's own infrastructure. Antares acts as an evidence-driven exploration agent that ranks relevant source files and shows the trace behind each result, keeping code in the customer environment. Cisco positions it as a foundation for partner-led secure code review, remediation planning and continuous vulnerability operations.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/partner/antares-and-the-partner-opportunity-local-efficient-trusted-ai-for-security>

PARTNERSHIP

Cisco

Platforms

2026-07-25

Tech Mahindra and Cisco Launch AI-Driven Security Service Edge

Tech Mahindra and Cisco announced a joint AI-powered Security Service Edge that pairs Tech Mahindra managed services with Cisco Secure Access SSE for cloud-native, zero-trust protection across users, devices, networks and locations. The offering consolidates secure web gateway, CASB, ZTNA, firewall-as-a-service and DLP to reduce complexity and enforce consistent policy. It targets enterprises expanding cloud, hybrid work and generative-AI initiatives.

<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/technology/tech-news/tech-mahindra-cisco-launch-ai-driven-security-service-edge/articleshow/132629315.cms>

PARTNERSHIP

Cisco

AI Security

2026-07-24

Cisco and AMD Bring Enterprise Security to Ryzen AI Halo Local AI Systems

Cisco and AMD announced enterprise-grade security and visibility for AMD Ryzen AI Halo local-inference systems, wrapping on-device AI with Cisco's security, observability and governance stack. The package combines Splunk observability, Cisco AI Defense and DefenseClaw on-device guardrails, and Cisco Cloud Control for unified policy, treating each AI node as a secure, managed enterprise endpoint. Network-level containment can quarantine misbehaving agents or models for investigation.

<https://www.networkworld.com/article/4201274/cisco-amd-expand-partnership-to-secure-distributed-ai-resources.html>

PARTNERSHIP

CrowdStrike

Platforms

2026-07-24

Cato Networks and CrowdStrike Unify Network and Endpoint Security

CrowdStrike and Cato Networks announced an integration uniting Cato's SASE platform with the CrowdStrike Falcon platform to correlate network and endpoint threat data in a single console. Use cases include accelerated investigations with Cato XOps and Falcon Discover, enhanced asset visibility and posture, and network telemetry feeding Falcon Next-Gen SIEM for stronger threat hunting. The move underscores broader convergence of network and endpoint security.

<https://ai-techpark.com/cato-networks-crowdstrike-partner-on-unified-security-operations/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Zscaler

Platforms

2026-07-24

Zscaler Launches Autonomous App Shield for Private Apps

Zscaler introduced Autonomous App Shield, a continuous protection approach for private applications that hides, segments and shields apps in real time as threats evolve. Built into the existing Zscaler platform, it replaces episodic, project-based hardening with intelligent, always-on defense, complemented by a Lateral Threat Bundle to further limit lateral movement. Zscaler frames the launch as answering demand for adaptive security in the AI era.

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/product-insights/autonomously-hide-segment-and-shield-private-app-defense-ai-era>

SECURITY ADVISORY

Check Point Software

Platforms

2026-07-24

Check Point Discloses Actively Exploited SmartConsole Zero-Day (CVE-2026-16232)

Check Point disclosed a critical authentication-bypass zero-day (CVE-2026-16232, CVSS 9.3) in its Security Management and SmartConsole products that is being exploited in the wild to gain full admin access and alter security policies. Check Point issued a Jumbo Hotfix addressing it plus two related flaws (CVE-2026-62144 and CVE-2026-62145) and notified affected customers. CISA added the flaw to its KEV catalog with a July 25 federal patch deadline.

<https://www.securityweek.com/new-check-point-zero-day-vulnerability-exploited-in-the-wild/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Cloudflare

Platforms

2026-07-24

Cloudflare Launches Internal DNS to Unify Public and Private DNS

Cloudflare announced Internal DNS, extending its public DNS platform to private and internal name resolution managed from the same global network and control plane. It consolidates split-horizon DNS sprawl and provides a single internal DNS service across multi-cloud environments, applying zero-trust and Gateway policies before internal names resolve. Cloudflare cites latency competitive with its public DNS by reusing the same infrastructure.

<https://www.networkworld.com/article/4201249/cloudflare-internal-dns-puts-public-and-private-dns-on-one-policy-engine.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare****AI Data Delivery**

2026-07-24

Cloudflare Splits AI Crawler Controls into Search, Agent and Training

Cloudflare rolled out granular AI crawler controls that let any site independently allow or block Search, Agent and Training bots, available on all plans including free. From September 15, 2026, new domains will block Agent and Training crawlers by default on ad-bearing pages while allowing Search. Cloudflare also expanded its Pay Per Crawl beta, acting as merchant of record so publishers can charge AI companies for data access.

<https://www.deeplearning.ai/the-batch/cloudflares-web-crawler-flare-up>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**AWS****AI Data Delivery**

2026-07-24

Claude Opus 5 Now Available on AWS via Amazon Bedrock

AWS announced availability of Anthropic's Claude Opus 5, its most capable Opus model, on Amazon Bedrock and the Claude platform on AWS. The fifth-generation model brings improvements in coding, knowledge work, visual understanding and long-running agentic tasks, deliverable through Bedrock's managed inference infrastructure. The launch strengthens AWS's position as a delivery platform for frontier AI model serving.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/machine-learning/introducing-claude-opus-5-on-aws-anthropics-most-capable-opus-model/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Mindgard****AI Security**

2026-07-25

Mindgard Launches Free AI Security Labs Red-Teaming Tool

Mindgard launched AI Security Labs, a free online red-teaming tool that lets engineers run automated AI security tests across 170+ attack scenarios against popular models and datasets. It delivers repeatable threat discovery and detailed reports on risks such as data leakage, model copying, evasion and jailbreaking, surfacing AI-specific vulnerabilities in minutes. Access is free with simple sign-up, with Azure Marketplace availability planned and GCP and AWS to follow.

<https://www.globalsecuritymag.com/mindgard-launched-mindguard-s-ai-security-lab.html>

BUSINESS UPDATE**Akamai****AI Data Delivery**

2026-07-26

Akamai Advances Distributed AI Cloud on Momentum of \$1.8B Anthropic Deal

Akamai's distributed AI cloud strategy drew fresh attention as its seven-year, \$1.8B cloud-infrastructure commitment with a frontier AI developer (identified as Anthropic) and a \$200M Nvidia RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell GPU deal underpinned roughly \$2B in new AI cloud business. CEO Tom Leighton argues Akamai's existing distributed footprint can deliver AI inference without hyperscale data centers, driving 40% year-over-year cloud infrastructure growth. The news lifted Akamai shares sharply.

<https://wowreseller.com/article/akamai-stock-soars-25-after-1-8-billion-ai-deal-what-you-need-to-know>

AWARD

Fastly

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-07-26

Fastly Named a 2026 Gartner Peer Insights Customers' Choice for Edge Distribution

Fastly was named a 2026 Gartner Peer Insights Customers' Choice for Edge Distribution Platforms, earning a 4.8/5 overall rating from 92 verified reviews and a 95% willingness-to-recommend score. The recognition follows seven consecutive years of Gartner WAAP Customers' Choice awards and reflects growing confidence in Fastly's edge cloud platform as enterprises expand AI initiatives. Executives cited customer trust in helping organizations move fast, stay secure and innovate at scale.

<https://tribune.net.ph/2026/07/26/fastly-earns-gartner-customers-choice-recognition>

PARTNERSHIP

Fastly

AI Data Delivery

2026-07-24

Fastly Joins Experian Agent Trust Ecosystem for Trusted AI Commerce

Fastly joined Experian's Agent Trust ecosystem to verify AI agent identities and authorize autonomous-commerce transactions in real time at the network edge. Using Experian's Human to Agent Binding, Fastly's programmable edge checks identity, delegated authority, intent and payment credentials before requests reach origin systems, interoperating with Know Your Agent tech such as Skyfire. The integration works with existing APIs and security controls without re-architecting infrastructure.

<https://apnews.com/press-release/business-wire/press-release-150cc5a2a3e746fc83285357e13c22b0>

PARTNERSHIP

HPE / Juniper Networks

AI Data Delivery

2026-07-26

ScanSource Expands Distribution Partnership to Include HPE Juniper Networking

ScanSource announced an expansion of its HPE partnership to add HPE Juniper Networking to its portfolio, broadening access for VARs, advisors, service providers and ISVs. The deal pairs networking and security solutions with tailored channel programs, marketing support and sales enablement, and provides partners access to an AI-enabled cloud platform to automate and optimize wireless, wired and SD-WAN networks. It reinforces HPE's push to scale its AI-native enterprise networking through the channel.

<https://www.channel-impact.com/scansource-announces-expansion-of-hpe-networking-partnership/>

PRODUCT UPDATE

Imperva (Thales)

Application Security

2026-07-26

Imperva (Thales) Ships July Cloud WAF and Client-Side Protection Updates

Imperva by Thales published its July 26, 2026 cloud security release, adding two new Cloud WAF SIEM violation types — Unrestricted File Upload and Sensitive Information Leakage — to improve threat logging. A Client-Side Protection beta now automatically authorizes trusted domains to cut manual reviews while preserving visibility and control. The release also mitigated several CVEs and adjusted API Security schema-protection timing for OPTIONS and HEAD requests.

<https://docs-cybersec.thalesgroup.com/bundle/cloud-application-security/page/release-notes/2026-07-26.htm>